

Chapter 1 — Arjuna-Viṣāda Yoga

अर्जुनविषादयोगः : అర్జునవిషాదయోగము

"The Yoga of Arjuna's Despondency" · 47 verses · The opening of the Bhagavad Gītā

The Gītā does not begin with a teaching — it begins with a **breakdown**.

Standing between the two armies at Kurukṣetra, Arjuna — the greatest warrior of his age — looks across at his teachers, cousins, uncles, and friends, and his hands drop. His bow slips. He cannot fight. He sits down on the chariot, overwhelmed.

This collapse is not weakness. It is the **honest moment** that every seeker must reach before real wisdom can be received. Chapter 1 sets up the entire Gītā as **Kṛṣṇa's response to Arjuna's despair** — and by extension, the response to *every* human being who has stood at a moral crossroads and asked, "*What should I do?*"

Essential verses of Chapter 1

BG 1.1 The very first verse — Dhṛtarāṣṭra asks Sañjaya what is happening on the battlefield

धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः ।

मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव किमकुर्वत सञ्जय ॥ १.१ ॥

ధర్మక్షేత్రే కురుక్షేత్రే సమవేతా యుయుత్సవః ।

మామకాః పాండవాశ్చైవ కిమకుర్వత సంజయ ॥ ౧.౧ ॥

dharma-kṣetre kuru-kṣetre samavetā yuyutsavaḥ |

māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāś caiva kim akurvata sañjaya |

"On the field of dharma, at Kurukṣetra — gathered, eager to fight — what did my sons and the Pāṇḍavas do, O Sañjaya?"

The Gītā opens with the word *dharma*. The battle isn't just military — it's **moral**. Every human life is a *dharma-kṣetra*.

Word-by-Word — 1.1

IAST	संस्कृत	తెలుగు	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>dharma-kṣetre</i>	धर्मक्षेत्रे	ధర్మక్షేత్రే	DHAR-ma-KSHE-tre	in the field of dharma (righteousness)
<i>kuru-kṣetre</i>	कुरुक्षेत्रे	కురుక్షేత్రే	KU-ru-KSHE-tre	at Kurukṣetra (the place)
<i>samavetāḥ</i>	समवेताः	సమవేతాః	SA-ma-VE-taah	assembled, gathered together
<i>yuyutsavaḥ</i>	युयुत्सवः	యుయుత్సవః	yu-YUT-sa-vah	eager / desiring to fight
<i>māmakāḥ</i>	मामकाः	మామకాః	MAA-ma-kaah	my own (sons — Duryodhana & brothers)
<i>pāṇḍavāḥ</i>	पाण्डवाः	పాండవాః	PAAN-da-vaah	the Pāṇḍavas (Yudhiṣṭhira & brothers)
<i>ca eva</i>	च एव	చ ఏవ	cha E-va	and also
<i>kim akurvata</i>	किम् अकुर्वत	కిమ్ అకుర్వత	kim a-KUR-va-ta	what did they do?
<i>sañjaya</i>	सञ्जय	సంజయ	san-JA-ya	O Sañjaya (the narrator)

